

DockIQ.AI — Explained Through Real Scenarios

A practical guide showing how DockIQ transforms dock-door operations

The Setting

Imagine a large cold-storage warehouse with **20 dock doors**. Trailers pull up, and forklift operators load or unload them. There are **3 supervisors** covering **20 operators** across the floor. Each operator has a **tablet** mounted on their forklift or at the dock door.

Scenario 1: "The Damaged Pallet"

■ WITHOUT DockIQ:

1. Operator Mike is unloading a trailer at Dock 12
2. He pulls out pallet #6 – it's crushed, product is spilling
3. Mike doesn't know what to do. Reject the whole pallet? Accept it partially? Who does he tell?
4. He parks his forklift, walks 400 feet to find Supervisor Sarah
5. Sarah is already dealing with another issue at Dock 3
6. Mike waits 8 minutes
7. Sarah walks back to Dock 12 with Mike (another 3 minutes)
8. Sarah looks at the damage, decides to partially accept
9. Mike writes the discrepancy on a paper form – chicken scratch, no photos, hard to read later
10. The trailer has been sitting open for 15 minutes (cold chain risk for frozen product)

Total time lost: ~20 minutes | **Knowledge captured:** A messy paper form in a filing cabinet

■ WITH DockIQ:

1. Operator Mike is unloading a trailer at Dock 12
2. He pulls out pallet #6 – it's crushed, product is spilling
3. Mike taps the DockIQ tablet → 'Report Issue'
4. He sees pre-filled info:
'Dock 12 | Trailer #T-4892 | Customer: Kroger
Product: Frozen Chicken Breasts'
5. He selects: Issue Type → 'Damaged Pallet', Severity → 'High' (System auto-suggests 'High' – perishable product)
6. He types or voice-dictates: 'Pallet 6 crushed on left side, about 8 cases damaged'
7. He taps Submit → Sarah gets an INSTANT notification:
'HIGH – Dock 12 – Damaged pallet – Frozen Chicken – Kroger'
8. While waiting, Mike taps 'What should I do?' in the AI chat
9. The AI responds (pulling from Kroger's SOP + company policy):
'For damaged frozen product (Kroger):
Step 1: Separate damaged cases from intact ones
Step 2: Check if product packaging is punctured
Step 3: Move intact cases to staging'

Step 4: Supervisor will authorize partial acceptance
Source: Kroger Receiving SOP v3.2, Section 4.1'
10. Mike starts separating cases. Sarah arrives in 3 minutes
(she already knows the full situation from the alert)
11. Discrepancy report is auto-generated with all details.

Total time lost: ~5 minutes | **Knowledge captured:** Digital record with full context, searchable forever

Scenario 2: "The Temperature Emergency"

■ WITHOUT DockIQ:

1. Operator Lisa is receiving a frozen seafood shipment at Dock 5
2. She checks the temperature probe: reads 28°F
(should be $\leq 0^{\circ}\text{F}$ – this is WAY too warm)
3. Lisa isn't sure of the exact cutoff. She's only been here 2 months.
4. She tries to radio Supervisor Tom – no answer (he's in the freezer)
5. She tries again – still nothing
6. She waits. The trailer is sitting open. Product getting warmer.
7. 12 minutes later, Tom responds. Walks over.
8. Tom checks his paper SOP binder. Finds the temp threshold.
Confirms rejection.
9. Lisa fills out paper rejection form. Tom calls the carrier.
10. Nobody flagged this to the Quality team until end of shift.

Total time lost: ~25 min | **Food safety risk:** HIGH | **Quality notified:** Hours later

■ WITH DockIQ:

1. Operator Lisa is receiving a frozen seafood shipment at Dock 5
2. She enters the temperature reading into the tablet: 28°F
3. DockIQ IMMEDIATELY flags this:
'CRITICAL – Temperature 28°F exceeds threshold ($\leq 0^{\circ}\text{F}$)
Product: Atlantic Salmon Fillets | Customer: Costco
FOOD SAFETY RISK – Immediate action required'
4. Three things happen simultaneously:
 - a) Supervisor Tom gets a CRITICAL alert
 - b) Quality Manager gets auto-notified
 - c) Lisa sees immediate guidance on her screen:
'CRITICAL TEMP DEVIATION – DO NOT ACCEPT:
- Do NOT unload any product
- Close the trailer doors immediately
- Do NOT sign the BOL
- Supervisor is being notified
Source: Cold Chain SOP, Section 2.3'
5. Lisa closes the trailer doors right away
6. Tom arrives in 4 minutes – he already knows what's happening
7. Rejection is logged digitally. Quality team already knows.
8. System notes: 3rd temp issue from this carrier this month

Total time lost: ~5 min | **Food safety risk:** MINIMIZED | **Quality notified:** Instant

Scenario 3: "The Wrong Product"

■ WITHOUT DockIQ:

1. Operator Jay is loading a trailer at Dock 18 for a Walmart order
2. He's told to load SKU #7742 (Organic Whole Milk, 1 gallon)
3. The warehouse picker staged SKU #7743 (Organic 2% Milk, 1 gallon) – the boxes look almost identical
4. Jay doesn't catch it. He loads 200 cases of the wrong milk.
5. The trailer ships. Walmart receives the wrong product 2 days later.
6. Walmart files a chargeback: \$4,200
7. Nobody at the warehouse knows what happened until Walmart complains

Savings on this single incident: \$0 (loss already happened)

■ WITH DockIQ:

1. Operator Jay is loading a trailer at Dock 18 for a Walmart order
2. DockIQ shows him the pick list:
'Load Plan – Walmart Order #W-9921:
Position 1: SKU #7742 – Organic Whole Milk 1gal – 200 cases
[Visual: Photo of the correct box with label highlighted]'
3. Jay scans a case barcode → it reads SKU #7743
4. DockIQ flags immediately:
'SKU MISMATCH
Expected: #7742 (Organic Whole Milk)
Scanned: #7743 (Organic 2% Milk)
DO NOT LOAD – wrong product staged'
5. Jay stops. Taps 'Report Issue' → supervisor is notified
6. The right product is re-staged. Correct order ships.
7. Walmart chargeback: \$0

Savings on this single incident: \$4,200

Scenario 4: "The New Employee"

■ WITHOUT DockIQ:

1. New operator Carlos, day 3 on the job, is assigned Dock 9
2. He's loading an order for a customer he's never handled before
3. This customer requires a very specific load pattern:
 - Heavy items on bottom, light on top
 - All labels facing outward
 - Maximum 2 pallets high
 - Slip sheets between every layer
4. Carlos doesn't know any of this. The info is in a binder in the supervisor's office.
5. He loads it the standard way – 3 pallets high, no slip sheets
6. Customer rejects the load at delivery → product damaged
7. Re-delivery cost + damaged product = \$6,000+

Cost of mistake: \$6,000+

■ WITH DockIQ:

1. New operator Carlos, day 3 on the job, is assigned Dock 9
2. DockIQ automatically shows him:

■ [LIGHT] on top, [HEAVY] on bottom■

■ Labels facing OUT ■

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4. He's unsure about slip sheets, types in chat:

5. AI responds: 'Slip sheets are located in Aisle 14, Bay C, bottom shelf. They are thin cardboard sheets (48x40 inches). Place one flat on top of each pallet layer before stacking.'

Cost of mistake: \$0 — prevented by real-time guidance

■ WITHOUT DockIQ:

8:00 AM – Mike radios about a damaged pallet (Dock 12)
8:02 AM – Jay walks over asking about a load sequence (Dock 18)
8:03 AM – Lisa radios about a temperature issue (Dock 5) ← CRITICAL
8:05 AM – Sarah goes to Dock 18 first (Jay got to her first)
8:15 AM – Finishes with Jay, heads to Dock 12
8:25 AM – Finishes with Mike, NOW goes to Dock 5
8:35 AM – Discovers the temp issue – but product has been sitting
in a warm trailer for 32 minutes now

Result: Critical food-safety issue handled last (32 min delay)

Sarah's tablet shows a prioritized queue:

[illegible]

■ Frozen Seafood – Lisa – 8:03 AM [GO TO DOCK 5] ■

Journal Pre-proof

■ Frozen Chicken – Mike – 8:00 AM [VIEW DETAILS] ■

[illegible]

■ Dairy - Jay - 8:02 AM [VIEW DETAILS] ■

[illegible]

8:08 AM – Temp issue handled in 5 minutes

(Lisa already closed doors following AI guidance)
8:12 AM – Goes to Dock 12
(Mike already separated damaged cases via AI guidance)
8:18 AM – Checks Dock 18
(Jay already figured it out from the AI chat)

Every issue triaged by urgency. Critical = first. Always.

Result: Critical issue handled first, two issues self-resolved by operators

The Simple Way to Think About It

Think of DockIQ as **three things combined into one tablet** at the dock door:

1	A Smart Assistant	Like having an experienced colleague standing next to every operator, whispering "here's wh
2	A Panic Button with Brains	Instead of running to find help, one tap sends the right person the right information, and the n
3	A Memory	Every issue, every resolution, every discrepancy is captured digitally, so the warehouse stops

The AI isn't replacing anyone. It's **giving operators confidence to handle routine issues themselves** and **giving supervisors the information to prioritize what actually matters**.